



Seats and Votes

Total Seats 543

	SEATS 2009*	SEATS 2004**	Gain/Loss
CONG+ DMK, TMC, NCP, MIM, NC, IUML, VCK, JMM AND OTHERS	261	217	+44
BJP+ JD(U), SS, SAD, AGP, INLD, RLD AND OTHERS	159	185	-26
OTHERS RJD, LJP, CPI(M), CPI, RSP, AIFB, SP, BSP, TRS, TDP, JD(S), PRP, PDP, BJD, AIADMK, PMK, MDMK AND THE REST	123	136	-13

* the tally for 2009 is a combination of wins and leads.

** 2004 tally is for 538 seats contested by coalition partners for the total 543 Lok Sabha seats. The allies in Congress+ and BJP+ vary for 2004 and 2009. The BJP later added five seats, taking its tally to 222.

The Comeback COUPLE

Sonia Gandhi, assisted by an audacious son and a performing prime minister, authors a sensational victory for the Congress. Now they have to deliver.

| By Prabhu Chawla |

The summer thriller 2009 has come to an end with a sensational piece of transmutation. For more than a decade, she was one of the powerful women in politics, commanding complete copyright over the conscience of a party whose story is inseparable from the evolution of the world's most volatile democracy. And in the history of the Dynasty that continues to dazzle India, she was one Gandhi—the only one—who embodied absolute power without formally being in power. Still, there was a struggle—the struggle between Sonia and Gandhi. Between the demands of reality and the